Feature: Vendor Vacation Mode

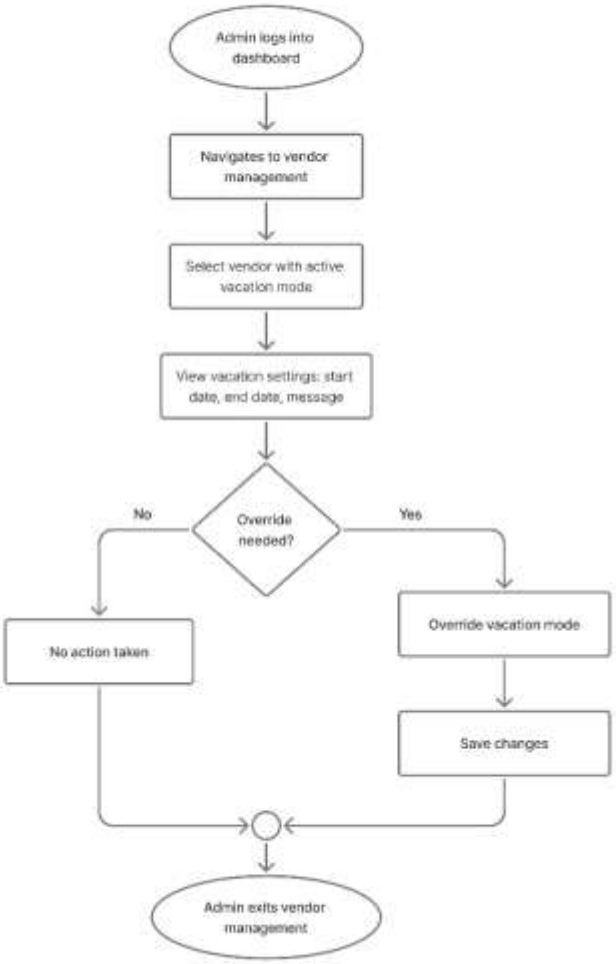
Feature Overview:

- Vendors will have the ability to schedule a temporary store closure (Vendor Vacation Mode).
- Vendors can set a start and end date for the closure.
- Vendors can add an optional message for customers informing them about the closure.
- During the closure, no new orders can be placed, but pending orders should still be processable by the vendor.
- Admins must have the ability to override the closure if necessary.

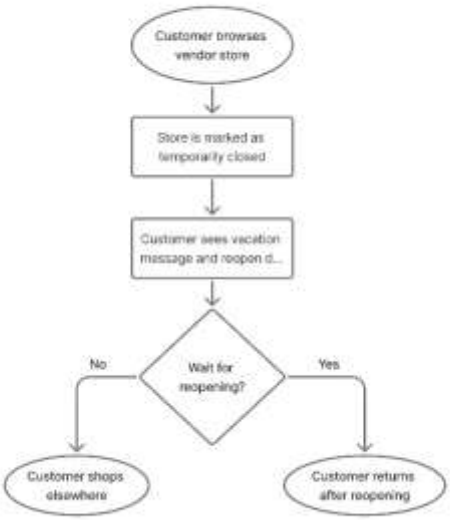
Affected Personas and Their Specific Goals for This Feature:

1. **Vendor**
    - **Primary Goal**:
      Vendors need a way to pause their store temporarily without having to manually stop everything, and also notify their customers in advance about the closure.
    - **Pain Point**:
      Currently, vendors may struggle to manage store downtime and continue fulfilling existing orders while stopping new orders from being placed.
2. **Admin**
    - **Primary Goal**:
      Admins need to manage store closures across multiple vendors and ensure that the closure is properly communicated to the customers, as well as have the ability to override the closure if required.
    - **Pain Point**:
      Admins might face difficulties in managing and enforcing vacation modes for vendors, especially in scenarios where the closure might be overridden or not correctly applied.
3. **Customer**
    - **Primary Goal**:
      Customers want to be aware of when the vendor’s store is on vacation and when it will be back open for new orders.
    - **Pain Point**:
      Customers may get frustrated if they attempt to place an order during a vendor's vacation without any communication about the unavailability.

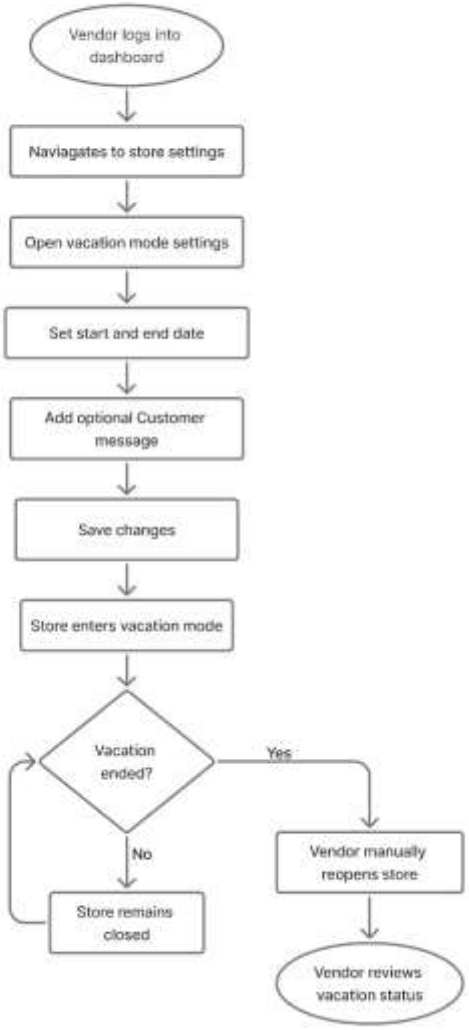
Admin User Flow



Customer User Flow



Vendor User Flow



User Story 1: As a vendor, I want to be able to set a vacation mode for my store, so that no new orders can be placed while I'm away, but I can still process pending orders.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Vendor can set a start date and end date for vacation mode.
- A clear message is displayed to customers, indicating that the store is in vacation mode.
- Customers cannot place new orders during the vacation period.

- Vendors can still process existing, pending orders.
- The vendor can reopen the store after the vacation period ends.

User Story 2: As an admin, I want the ability to override a vendor's vacation mode, so that I can ensure the marketplace operates smoothly in case of any urgent situations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Admin can view the vendor's vacation settings (dates, message).
- Admin can override the vacation mode by extending, ending early, or modifying the message.
- Admin actions must be logged for transparency.

User Story 3: As a customer, I want to be notified when a vendor's store is in vacation mode, so that I can decide whether to wait or shop elsewhere.

Acceptance Criteria:

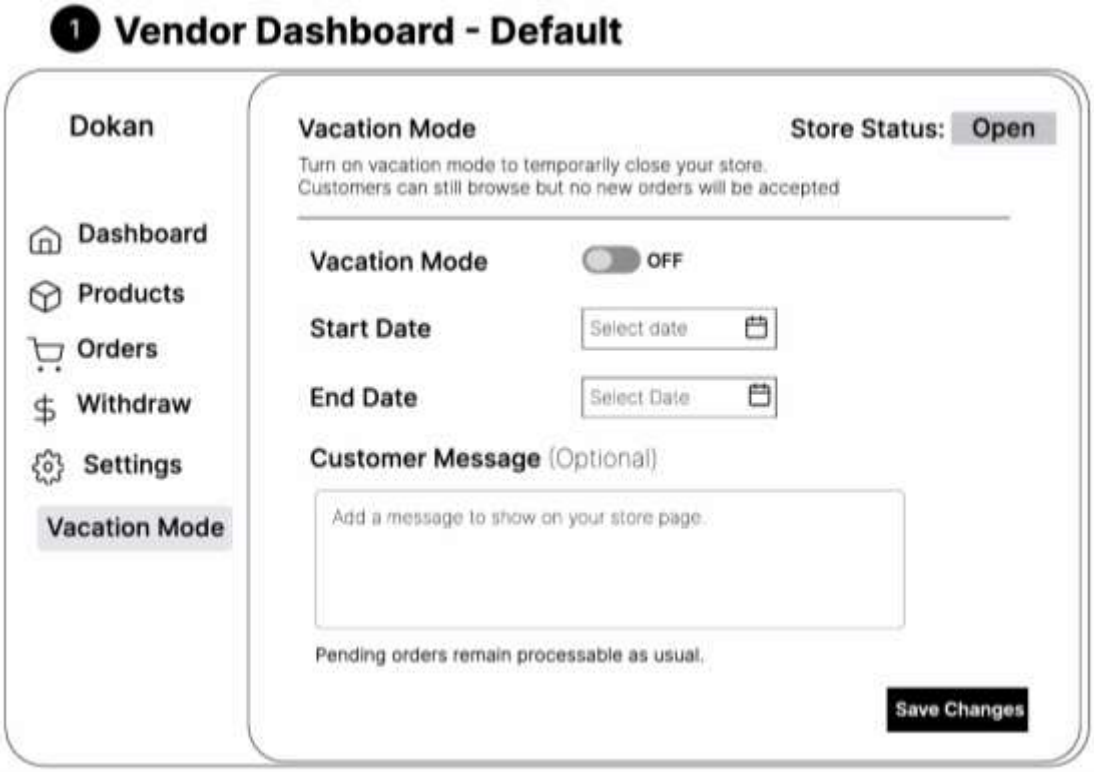
- The customer sees a notice when browsing a vendor's store in vacation mode.
- The notice includes the dates when the store will reopen, and any message the vendor has set.
- The notice should be visible across product pages and checkout.

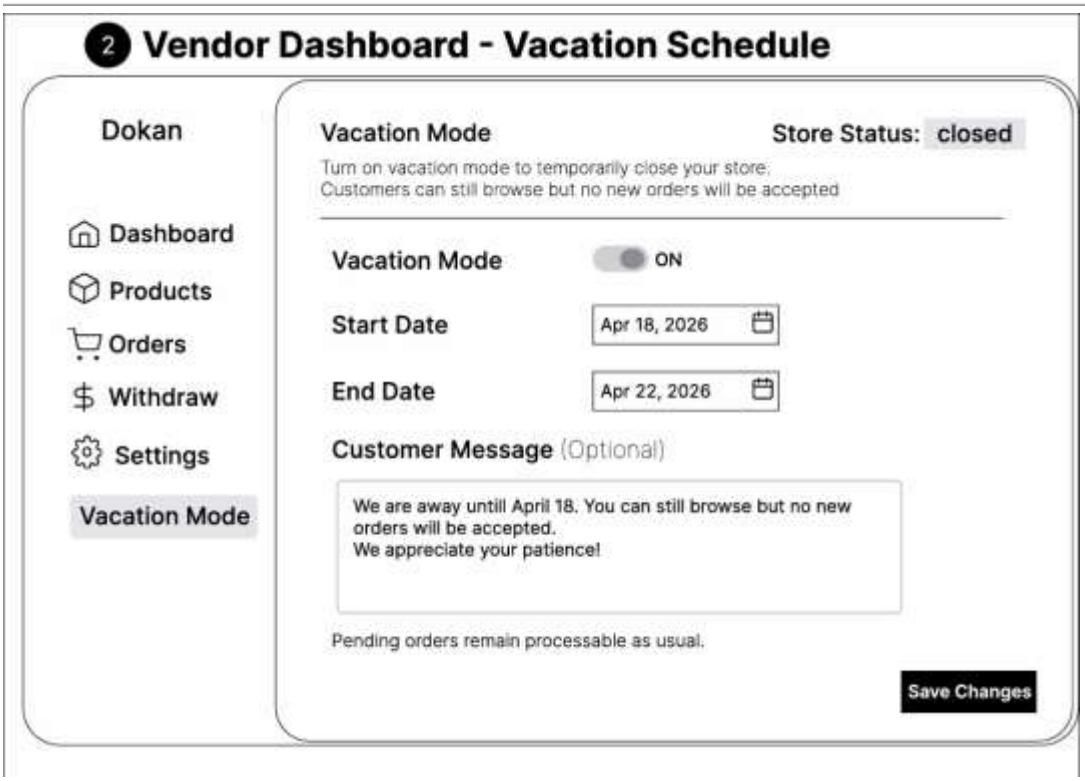
Edge Cases:

1. **Active cart when store closes**:
   If a customer has products in the cart when the store goes into vacation mode, the cart should still function normally (products can be purchased or removed).
2. **Admin override mid-vacation**:
   If the admin decides to end the vacation mode early, the store should immediately reopen, and the customer will no longer see the "vacation mode" notice.
3. **End date in the past**:
   If the vendor sets an end date in the past, the system should either prevent it or automatically reset the store to open, depending on admin configuration.
4. **Vendor forgets to re-open the store**:
   After the vacation period ends, the system should **automatically reopen the store** unless the vendor manually sets it to remain closed.
5. **Vendor tries to close store during active orders**:
   The system should allow vacation mode to be activated but should still allow vendors to fulfill pending orders.
6. **Multiple vendors on vacation mode at the same time**:
   Ensure the system can handle multiple vendors setting vacation mode simultaneously and still allow customers to shop from other vendors.
7. **Customer tries to place an order during vacation mode**:
   If the store is in vacation mode, customers should be prevented from adding items to the cart, with a message explaining that orders cannot be placed during this period.

8. **Vacation mode when a product is out of stock**:
   If a vendor places the store on vacation and an item goes out of stock during the vacation, it should be hidden from customers until the store is reopened.

Wireframes:





3 Storefront - Store Closed

My Store Shop About Contact

Search products 2

This store is temporarily closed

We are away untill April 18. You can still browse but no new orders will be accepted.
We appreciate your patience!

Reopening on: April 22, 2026

All Categories

Sort by: Default

T-shirt	T-shirt	T-shirt	T-shirt
$10.00	$10.00	$10.00	$10.00
Add to cart	Add to cart	Add to cart	Add to cart
Store is closed	Store is closed	Store is closed	Store is closed

4 Cart/Checkout - Closed Store

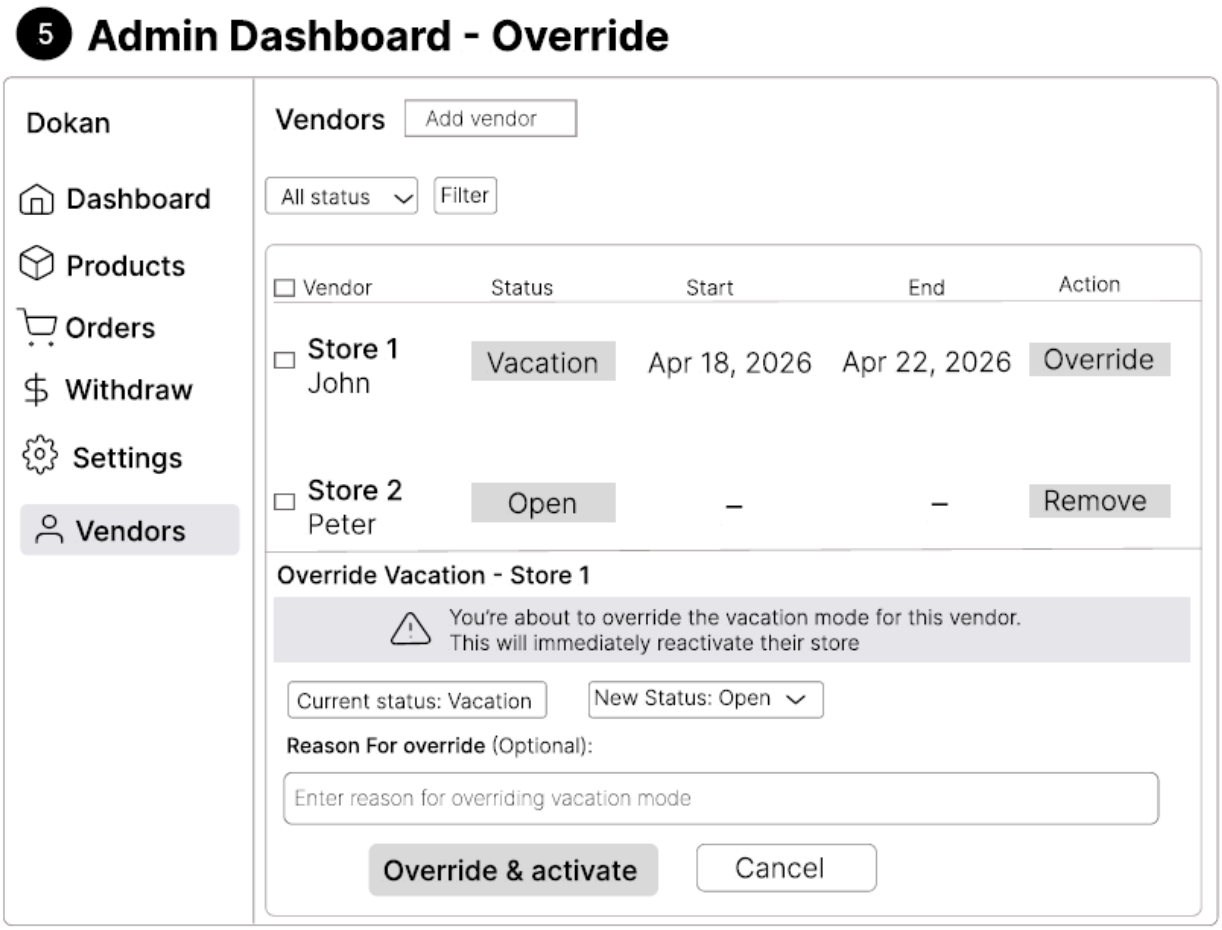
Cart

One or more items are from a closed store

You cannot place a new order for these items while the store is on vacation.

Product	Store	Price	Qty	Subtotal	Status/Action
T-Shirt Variation: Blue/M	Store 1 Closed	$10.00	1	$10.00	Unavailable Remove
Shirt Variation: White/M	Store 2 Open	$20.00	1	$20.00	Available Remove

Proceed to checkout



Technical Considerations

- **Data Stored**:
  - Vacation Mode status (on/off).
  - Start Date and End Date of vacation.
  - Message to customers.
  - Vendor's store status (open/closed).
- **Existing Flows Affected**:
  - Checkout flow will be affected when the store is in vacation mode (prevents new orders).
  - Vendor's order processing capabilities will continue even if the store is closed.
- **Cart Impact**:
  - If a customer adds items to the cart before vacation mode starts, the cart remains active, but they cannot proceed with checkout until the store reopens.

Competitor Check

  - Some multivendor plugins (like WC Vendors Pro or WooCommerce Product Vendors) offer vacation modes, but Dokan's integration may be more robust.

- How they scoped it: Competitors allow vendors to activate vacation mode manually, but may not have an integrated messaging system or the ability to override by admins.
- What they missed: Many competitors do not allow automatic reopening or have poorly integrated communication with customers during the vacation period.

Business Value: This feature is critical for vendor management and customer satisfaction, ensuring vendors can take time off without interrupting ongoing operations and maintaining transparency with customers.
Cost of Not Building It: Vendors may resort to disabling their stores manually, causing customer confusion or dissatisfaction due to lack of communication. This could lead to lost sales and increased customer support inquiries.

MVP Scope
v1:
- Allow vendors to set start and end dates for vacation mode.
- Allow vendors to add a custom message for customers.
- Admins can override vacation mode.

v2:
- Automatically reopen the store after vacation mode ends.
- Handle multiple vendors in vacation mode simultaneously.
- Allow customers to place orders with notifications if another vendor is available.